

12 Fabulous Frugal Party Ideas



Need ideas for having a fabulous party with minimal money, time, and catering abilities? If you've got gracious friends, just a bit of cash, and time to clean your home, you'll likely enjoy these 12 ideas for having a party to remember.

1. Topping-optional party

One of my all-time favorite parties was a nacho party. Guests enjoyed trying nachos topped with various types of cheese, beans, and veggies. You can do this with pizza and baked potato,

too. Anything that can use a wide variety of toppings will work.

2. Soup and sandwich party

This is perfect for cold days and nights. Make simple but classic sandwiches like grilled cheese and PB&J. They can even be made to order, cutting down on your party prepping work. Chicken and noodle soup is usually a crowd-pleaser. For a more grown-up event, whip up this onion soup recipe (you'll need 4 medium onions, chopped, canola oil, 2 cans beef consommé, toast cut into 1–2-inch pieces, and mozzarella cheese; sauté onions until soft, mix onions with consommé and 2 cans of water, and simmer for an hour or so; serve topped with toast and cheese).

3. Lasagna and spaghetti pie can serve many

If you're not in the mood for cooking, try one of your grocer's frozen lasagnas or go low-key with frozen raviolis. If you want to save money, bake a spaghetti pie (you'll need 8 oz. spaghetti, 16 oz. spaghetti sauce, 6 oz. of mozzarella cheese and cheddar cheese, and parmesan cheese; layer half of the sauce, uncooked noodles, and cheeses two times; bake covered at 350°F for an hour; then uncover